
Hoping I'm not lost in the shuffle.

From Amanda Bowlds <mandy_b123@hotmail.com>

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Dear Callaway County,

I'm a 10 year resident and home owner of Fulton, Missouri, and I wanted to formally express my concerns regarding the proposed data center project in Callaway County unless meaningful protections are put in place for the surrounding community first.

I'm not against growth or economic development. I understand projects like this can bring tax revenue and attention to the area. But AI data centers are not small, quiet operations. They are massive industrial facilities with equally massive demands on power, water, infrastructure, and the environment. I believe those impacts deserve serious review before anything moves forward.

Some of my biggest concerns are:

Environmental impact

These facilities consume enormous amounts of water and generate constant industrial noise from cooling systems, generators, and infrastructure. That affects nearby residents, farmland, and wildlife.

Utility strain and rising costs

The energy demand required to support large scale AI operations is significant. I worry local residents could ultimately feel that burden through higher utility costs or grid reliability issues.

Rural land use and community character

Callaway County is made up of agricultural land, open space, and rural communities. Projects of this scale fundamentally change the landscape and should be evaluated with that in mind.

If projects like this are going to move forward, I strongly encourage the county to require safeguards that ensure these companies operate as responsible neighbors, not unchecked industrial users.

At minimum, I would ask the commission to consider:

- Strict noise mitigation requirements with enforceable limits at property lines
- Protections against excessive water and electrical usage that could impact residents
- Restrictions on building in floodplains or environmentally sensitive areas
- Independent studies on thermal pollution and potential "heat dome" impacts on surrounding agriculture and ecosystems

Most importantly, I urge the commission to place a temporary moratorium on approval until a comprehensive environmental and infrastructure impact study can be completed and reviewed publicly.

I appreciate your time and consideration, and I hope the long term well being of Callaway County residents remains the priority in decisions like these.

Sincerely,

Amanda Bowlds
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